This pragmatic but pretty Pune apartment is built around a family's daily rituals creating a timeless sanctuary that resists the need for alteration

By **KOMAL MITTAL AND NINADA KASHYAP**

Photographs by STUDIO COLOURBLIND



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In our business, a two-year possession freeze is usually an absolute death sentence for a blueprint. You leave the studio with a perfectly balanced, deeply considered layout and by the time you shake hands back on-site, the gloss of the zeitgeist has shifted. Yet, when the dust settled on the Manik family's 1,700 sq ft, four-bedroom Pune apartment, the original design stood completely untouched, unbothered by the lapse of time. It is a delicious victory and it proves a fundamental truth, if you design for the quiet choreography of a family's daily rituals rather than what pops on a glowing screen, the space becomes entirely immune to the calendar.

Soft Horizons and Subtle Roots

Our initial brief was to create a contemporary home that could subtly blend the couple's diverse cultural backgrounds while accommodating their active daily lifestyles. To achieve this, we avoided heavy, dominant cultural iconography. Instead, we chose the path of abstraction, drawing gently from the family's origins to establish a quiet sense of familiarity. We began by replacing standard vitrified tile flooring with matte, stone-finish tiles and finished the walls in raw lime plaster. This structural decision introduced a beautiful sense of grain, depth and imperfection that mimics the spirit of traditional Indian homes. Because the apartment faces intense western sunlight in the afternoon, this soft grey envelope works practically to temper the harsh glare, diffusing a warm, lived-in comfort across the rooms. Against this highly textured, muted canvas, we introduced earthy accents through custom artwork and soft furnishings that settle into the space without disrupting its visual harmony.

Geometry of the Everyday

The heart of the home lies in its interconnected social spaces, where cultural memories are woven directly into daily routines. Running along the outer edge of the living room floor is a contrasting patterned border, a modern nod to the warm, defining perimeters found in traditional Indian courtyard homes. Positioned centrally within this layout is a double-sided wooden *oonjal* (swing) fitted with brass knobs and hooked chains, acting as a functional divider

